



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: SOAR Academy
School Website: <https://soaracademy.net/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Soar Academy GA 30907 presents a distinctive blend of private, non-traditional education focused on neuro-divergent learners, individualized learning plans, and project-based modalities. Public materials emphasize a mission-driven approach to education that centers on tailoring instruction to each child's learning style, leveraging research and discovery, and preparing students for higher learning and life-long creativity. While these strengths align with several values commonly associated with classical education (e.g., formation of character, emphasis on student-centered formation, community and family engagement), the site also foregrounds contemporary, experiential, and multi-modal methods (lecture-style teaching, multi-sensory learning, and exploration Fridays) and explicit project-based learning approaches that are not typically central to classical pedagogy as defined by the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School.

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale:

- Element 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations): Not Classical. Public materials do not demonstrate grounded theological commitments or liturgical practices. The site emphasizes individualized learning and neurodivergent supports rather than explicit transcendental or liturgical foundations. Evidence cited shows a private, non-traditional learning environment and accredited status, with no explicit theological program described.
- Element 2 (Purpose & Goal): Somewhat Classical. The school emphasizes formation and preparing students for higher learning, with a focus on tailoring education to individual students and fostering life-long learners. However, explicit reference to truth, goodness, and beauty as real transcendent aims or a teleological framework is not clearly articulated in the materials. The mission/vision language points toward formation and excellence rather than purely job-readiness.
- Element 3 (Curriculum): Not Classical. Public materials emphasize multiple instructional modalities (lecture-style, multi-sensory, computer/video learning) and a programmatic emphasis on exploration rather than the classical triad of grammar-logic-rhetoric and Great Books literacy. The explicit Great Books/Great Conversation cadence and Seven Liberal Arts foundation are not described in public pages.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Not Classical (leaning toward contemporary, experiential methods). While there is evidence of some contemplative/mentoring aspects (e.g., small classes, individualized support), the predominant methods highlighted are project-based, hands-on, and exploratory rather than Socratic seminars and structured classical pedagogy.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Somewhat Classical. The site frames teachers as dedicated professionals and mentors; it also references a living curriculum and strong staff involvement. However, there is also explicit note that not all teachers are SPED-certified or licensed, suggesting a mixture of formal credentialing and on-the-job learning. This combination aligns with "model teachers" and "living curriculum" ideas but lacks consistent classical credentialing norms.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): Classical. The school actively partners with families (PTO, volunteer sign-up, parent portals, staff pages, public mentions of family involvement) and demonstrates open channels for parental engagement, which aligns well with classical expectations for parent partnerships and community formation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials describe a non-traditional learning environment and emphasis on individualized education rather than stated theological grounding. The site highlights accreditation and personalized learning rather than explicit theology or liturgical practice.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: limited to phrases about character formation in a broad sense (not explicitly theological).
- Negative keywords present: secular/values-neutral framing is not explicit but the absence of theology or liturgical practices signals alignment away from a distinctly religious-metaphysical program.
- Why this rating
- The absence of explicit transcendental moral realism, theological grounding, liturgical practices, or sacred communal worship suggests this category does not align with classical religious-metaphysical foundations.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission and vision emphasize personalized formation, lifelong learning, and preparing for higher education, with a focus on forming character and abilities rather than merely delivering information. “We empower students to educate themselves through research, project-based learning, and discovery,” and “Our Vision ... all students prepare for higher learning post high school.”
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, life-long learners, character formation (implied), liberal-arts-like aims (via formation emphasis), pursuit of higher learning.
- Negative keywords present: explicit references to vocational/workforce emphasis are not central; however, the site emphasizes project-based and discovery experiences rather than purely contemplative or classical “paideia” formation language.
- Why this rating
- There is a clear aim beyond rote information (formation, higher learning, lifelong learning) but the explicit classical-teleological vocabulary (truth/goodness/beauty, telos) and direct framing around a classical aim is not strongly stated. This category nudges toward classical formation but is not fully explicit in the traditional sense.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Curriculum description emphasizes a mix of instructional modalities: lecture-style learning, computer/video-based learning, multi-sensory experiences, and a transformational engagement program (Exploration Fridays). Great Books, grammar/logic/rhetoric, or sustained Great Conversation are not described as curriculum anchors.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords from classical lists (Great Books, Seven Liberal Arts, Great Conversation) are not present in the school’s public materials.
- Negative keywords: presence of “project-based learning” and multi-modal instruction aligns with non-classical approaches per the Six Essential Elements negative indicators.
- Why this rating
- The curriculum is described through contemporary modalities and engagement programs rather than classical liberal arts pillars and Great Books pedagogy. This aligns more with not-Classical than with classical.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site highlights lecture-style instruction, multi-sensory learning, exploration Fridays, and project-based learning. Upper-level Socratic seminars and traditional classical rhetoric instruction are not described as standard pedagogy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords (Socratic dialogue, memory work, recitation, etc.) are not evidenced in the public content; rather, the opposite is emphasized (project-based, experiential, multiple modalities).
- Negative keywords: explicit project-based learning dominance and experiential learning emphasis as primary pedagogy indicators.
- Why this rating
- The predominant pedagogy is contemporary and experiential rather than classical, which places it in the Not Classical category for pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site describes dedicated teachers and a “living curriculum” and emphasizes mentorship and character development. It also notes that not all teachers are SPED-certified, suggesting a blended credentialing approach rather than a strict classical faculty model.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: model teachers and mentors, living curriculum, faculty as core, mentorship.
- Negative keywords present: credentialing variability (not all SPED-certified or licensed), which diverges from a strict classical faculty model that emphasizes deep training in classical pedagogy.
- Why this rating
- The presence of mentorship, living curriculum, and a supportive faculty culture aligns with classical ideals, albeit tempered by credentialing variability. This yields a Somewhat Classical rating for Faculty.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site emphasizes partnerships with families, involvement through PTO, volunteer sign-up, parent portals, and openness to parental engagement (experiential classroom experiences, scholarships, and staff connections show active family partnership).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent involvement, living tradition in the family, parent formation (through book studies or gatherings) and parent participation in school life (PTO, volunteer opportunities, open campus).
- Negative keywords: none evident in public content; the school appears to encourage strong parental involvement and community engagement.
- Why this rating
- The presence of explicit parent partnership, family involvement, and open campus vibes align closely with classical expectations for Parents & Community engagement.

Aggregate Assessment

- CLASSICAL: 1 category (Element 6)
- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: 2 categories (Categories 5; Element 2 loosely)
- NOT CLASSICAL: 3 categories (Categories 1, 3, 4)

Overall, the school sits in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL range due to its strong parental/community alignment and a faculty culture that leans toward the classical ideal of a living curriculum, tempered by non-classical pedagogical and curricular modalities and limited explicit classical metaphysical/theological framing. The aggregate classification is thus SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 4 (Pedagogy): Introduce classical core elements as anchors
- Explicitly incorporate Seven Liberal Arts foundations (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as a curricular spine; build a program around Great Books and Great Conversation, and integrate historical texts that illuminate the development of Western civilization.
- Adopt Socratic dialogue as a formal pedagogy in upper grades (e.g., regular Socratic seminars or Paideia-style practice) to cultivate dialectical reasoning and virtuous inquiry.
- Restore and emphasize memory-work and recitation (Scholé practices) to support retention and moral formation.
- Reduce early-stage reliance on lecture-style and constant multi-modal delivery as the sole mode; balance with disciplined, classical study routines that emphasize contemplative learning and intellectual formation.
- For Element 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations): Clarify or affirm metaphysical commitments if desired
- If a classical/metaphysical dimension is intended, articulate a clear stance on truth, goodness, beauty, and whether theology or sacred traditions are integrated into the curriculum as a governing principle.
- If non-sectarian, be explicit about the value framework (e.g., natural law, teleology, or a universalist tradition) to align with transcendental ideals.
- For Element 2 (Purpose & Goal): Make telos explicit
- Use language around telos, truth, goodness, and beauty to orient the curriculum toward objective standards and perennial questions, rather than solely toward personalized learning outcomes.
- For Element 5 (Faculty): Strengthen the classical faculty model
- Invest in a target profile for teachers that mirrors classical masters (living curriculum, mentorship, mastery of classical pedagogy) and pursue targeted professional development to deepen classical-methodology skills across the faculty.
- For Element 6 (Parents & Community): Maintain and deepen partnerships
- Expand parental education and classical book clubs to deepen family formation and ensure alignment between home and school in the classical project.

ABSTRACT

Soar Academy GA 30907 demonstrates a mixed, non-traditional approach with several classical-aligned features (formation of students, strong parent/community engagement, and a living faculty culture) but also prominent contemporary modalities (lecture-style instruction, multi-sensory learning, and project-based experiences). The keyword analysis against the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School indicates a primary alignment with classical ideals in Element 6 (Parents & Community) and a partial alignment in Element 5 (Faculty). Categories 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations), 3 (Curriculum), and 4 (Pedagogy) show non-classical traits due to a lack of explicit metaphysical/theological grounding, absence of classical Great Books infrastructure, and emphasis on modern pedagogies. Element 2 (Purpose & Goal) reflects a nuanced blend: formation and lifelong learning are evident, but explicit classical telos language remains underdeveloped in public materials.

Overall, Soar Academy GA 30907 is BEST DESCRIBED AS SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with substantial strengths in parental engagement and a living-faculty approach, but with clear opportunities to integrate classical curriculum anchors (Great Books, Trivium), traditional pedagogical methods (Socratic inquiry, memorization, and disciplined contemplative study), and explicit metaphysical framing to move toward full CLASSICAL status.

Notes on evidence and sources:

- Public materials demonstrating non-traditional pedagogy and project-based learning, mission/vision language, and family/community emphasis: Soar Academy site content (e.g., “Auditory Processing Disorder – Soar Academy” and “Your Student can soar with SOAR” pages) and enrollment pages.

- Evidence of curriculum modalities (lecture-style, multi-sensory learning, Exploration Fridays) and project-based approaches: Soar Academy public curriculum materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword framework (Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1)) and related lexicon:
- Core positive/negative keyword sets: Six Essential Elements document (positive/negative keywords), including “Seven Liberal Arts,” “Great Books,” “Socratic dialogue,” “Scholé,” etc.
- Classical lexicon for category interpretation (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, etc.).

Key sources cited in this evaluation:

- Soar Academy public materials (evidence of mission, modalities, and community engagement):
- Curriculum modalities and classroom practices (lecture-style, multi-sensory, Exploration Fridays, etc.):
- Community/Parental engagement (PTO, volunteer sign-up, open access, parent portals):
- Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, and other classical criteria from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) (positive/negative keyword sets and structure):
- Classical lexicon (positive/negative indicators across categories):

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
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